

Redesigning a Digital Interaction for Better Usability

Problem Identification

Digital System with Usability Issues: UGC Website

The University Grants Commission (UGC) website is a vital digital portal for students, academicians, researchers, and administrative staff across the country. It serves as the primary source for accessing critical information regarding scholarships, grants, university affiliations, regulatory updates, and notifications. However, the current interface presents significant usability barriers that impede efficient access to essential services, frustrating its diverse user base.

Identified Usability Issues

- **Poor Information Architecture & Navigation:** Information is buried under complex. Key user tasks such as finding specific scholarship announcements, checking university recognition status, or locating application guidelines, require excessive clicks and backtracking.
- **Low Speed of User Task Performance:** The website suffers from slow page load times, and processes are unnecessarily lengthy. For example, downloading a common form or finding the contact details for a specific department often involves navigating through multiple poorly labeled sections.
- **High User Error Rate:** Critical forms and instructions are often ambiguous. Users frequently report submitting incorrect documents or missing deadlines due to unclear procedural steps and a lack of intuitive guidance, leading to application rejections and rework.
- **Low Subjective User Satisfaction:** The website's outdated visual design, inconsistent layouts, and lack of mobile responsiveness create a perception of unreliability and inaccessibility. Users consistently express frustration and lack of trust in the platform.
- **Poor User Retention Over Time:** Users, particularly students and researchers, actively seek unofficial forums and social media groups for information they should be able to find reliably on the official UGC site, undermining its authority and purpose.

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